

MarEng Grammar

THE PRESENT CONTINUOUS / The Ing-form

Study these sentences:

What are you doing?

I am listening to the weather forecast.

What is Captain James doing? The Captain is giving orders on the bridge.

What is John doing? He is watching the radar screen.

What are the deckhands doing? They are casting off from the quay.

The Marina is leaving the Port of Santander.

A pilot boat is approaching our vessel.

We are entering the main fairway.

You are proceeding at a dangerous speed.

THE PRESENT CONTINUOUS - USE

The present continuous form is used only when speaking of a **continuous action** that is happening **right now**. It can also be used about an action that will happen **in the very near future**.

E.g. I **am flying** to London **this evening**.

THE PRESENT CONTINUOUS - FORMATION

THE ING -FORM

The Present Continuous is formed by **the present of the auxiliary to be + the ending -ing** linked to the main verb.

I am entering fairway

you are entering fairway

he is entering fairway

she is entering fairway

it is entering fairway

we are entering fairway

you are entering fairway

they are entering fairway

NOTE: The following changes take place when adding the ending -ing:

a verb ending in silent -e drops the vowel

Ex. come coming

after a short vowel the consonant doubles

Ex. sit sitting

-ie changes into -y at the end of a verb

Ex. lie lying

 tie tying

BUT: cry crying

THE PRESENT CONTINUOUS QUESTIONS

Questions are formed by reversing the order of the auxiliary and the main verb:

Example: Are you entering the fairway at Buoy No 3?

Is the Diana heaving up anchor?

Is the wind increasing?

What speed are they making?